ANNOTATED BIBLIOGRAPHY

Magnifica Humanitas and AI Alignment

A source-by-source guide to the 29 references in the Gemini research report, with evidence type, research use, limitations, and a cleaned reading path.

Companion to: Value Alignment and the Anthropological Framework of Magnifica Humanitas
Coverage: theology, AI alignment, personhood, institutions, science, and education
Prepared: October 2026

00

The bibliography needs evidence weighting

The report's works cited list is broad but uneven. It combines scholarship with journalism, institutional interpretation, blogs, Reddit threads, profile pages, a reposted figure, and one duplicate paper. This guide preserves all 29 entries while making those differences explicit.

RESEARCH ANCHORS

Peer-reviewed papers, conference proceedings, official documents, and clearly identified scholarly preprints. Use these for the report's central technical and normative claims.

EXPERT INTERPRETATION

Named scholars, institutional Q&As, and specialist essays. Useful for framing and explanation; verify decisive claims against primary texts or research.

RECEPTION EVIDENCE

Journalism and commentary show how the encyclical was discussed. They do not independently validate model behavior, consciousness, or governance efficacy.

DISCOVERY ONLY

Wikipedia, Reddit, author profiles, index pages, and isolated figures help locate material but should not anchor substantive conclusions.

Primary-source correction

The report does not list the official Vatican edition of *Magnifica Humanitas*. For paragraph-level interpretation, use the Holy See text first: official English edition. This companion adds that locator without renumbering the report's 29 entries.

Editorial note. "Stable source record" means the link was independently resolved or appeared intact in the supplied report. Missing locators are flagged rather than reconstructed from broken line wraps.

01 Pope’s First Document Promotes Human Life in Age of AI

INSTITUTIONAL NEWS

The Southern Cross, 2026

Provides a concise news account of the encyclical’s release and human-dignity framing. It is useful for chronology and reception, not for close textual interpretation or technical claims about alignment. As diocesan news, it has clear institutional context but is not an independent scholarly analysis. Use it to orient readers, then move to the encyclical itself for authoritative wording.

Stable source record

02 Magnifica humanitas

TERTIARY REFERENCE

Wikipedia, 2026

Offers a quick map of publication details, themes, and public reception. Its value is navigational: it can point readers toward primary documents and major commentary. Because it is collaboratively edited and can change, it should not anchor claims about paragraph-level doctrine, chronology, or scholarly consensus. The report relies on it as background; serious analysis should cite the official Vatican text instead.

Stable source record

03 Magnifica Humanitas: The Pope Writes Like the Machine He Fears

COMMENTARY

David Boles, Boles Blogs, 2026

A polemical response that illustrates one strand of public criticism: whether the document’s language and production reproduce the technological style it challenges. This is evidence of reception, not evidence about AI behavior or the encyclical’s authoritative meaning. It is most useful in a discourse-analysis section that contrasts theological advocacy with skeptical cultural commentary.

Stable source record

04 Magnifica Humanitas (Encyclical of Pope Leo XIV, 15 May 2026)

COMMUNITY DISCUSSION

Reddit discussion thread, r/slatestarcodex, 2026

Captures informal, technically literate reactions and competing interpretations. It may reveal questions that formal commentary overlooks, but authorship, expertise, and claims are uneven. Treat it as a discovery aid or reception artifact only. It should not be used to establish what the encyclical says, what laboratories have shown, or what academic literature concludes.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report's original locator.

05 Q&A: Fordham Papal Expert Unpacks Pope Leo's Encyclical on AI

EXPERT INTERVIEW

Fordham News, 2026

Provides institutionally situated theological interpretation in an accessible question-and-answer format. Its strength is explanatory context: it can connect the encyclical to Catholic social teaching and papal history. It remains a secondary interpretation rather than the primary text, and the interview format is not a substitute for peer-reviewed argument. Use it to clarify concepts, then verify decisive claims against the encyclical.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report's original locator.

06 Magnifica Humanitas: Pope Leo XIV's AI Encyclical

INDUSTRY BLOG

ExplainX.ai, 2026

Translates the encyclical into AI-governance language and may help practitioners see operational implications. The trade-off is evidentiary: a vendor-style explainer can simplify theological nuance and may frame the document around current product concerns. Use it for practitioner reception and terminology, not as an independent authority on doctrine, empirical safety research, or legal obligations.

Stable source record

07 Industry Self-Flagging and the Insufficiency Critique of Alignment

SCHOLARLY EDITORIAL

Steven Umbrello. Journal of Ethics and Emerging Technologies 36(2), 2026. DOI 10.55613/jeet.v36i2.251

This is the report's clearest conceptual bridge between Magnifica Humanitas and frontier-lab research. Umbrello argues that privately selected values remain structurally insufficient even when alignment is technically effective, and he reads recent industry papers as convergent evidence. The piece is an editorial synthesis, not a new experiment; its contribution is interpretive framing and a research agenda for public deliberation and value-sensitive design.

Stable source record

08 From Protocols to Evidence: Bounded Claims for AI in Service of the Common Good

CONFERENCE PAPER

Nitesh V. Chawla and Paolo Benanti. ACM AI Summit, 2026. DOI 10.1145/3806096.3844885

Introduces RISE - Responsibility, Inclusivity, Safety, and Empowerment - and distinguishes evidence-bounded deployment claims from governance limits that favorable measurements cannot override. The paper is particularly useful for turning the report's broad moral concerns into audit questions about institutions, populations, workflows, and accountability. Its framework structures judgment rather than proving that any deployment is legitimate; moral and political evaluation still remains necessary.

Stable source record

09 Magnifica Humanitas

COMMENTARY

J Off the Record, 2026

A public-facing interpretation of the encyclical. Its main value is rhetorical and comparative: it shows how the document travels outside formal theology into general technology debate. The source does not provide an empirical method or peer-review signal, so it should not carry technical conclusions. Use it to sample reception or identify themes for verification in stronger sources.

Stable source record

10 AI: Developments and Responses

COMMENTARY

Longbeard, 2026

Surveys contemporary AI developments and social responses in a broad, accessible register. In the report, it functions as contextual scaffolding rather than a discrete academic contribution. Because broad blog syntheses can blend reporting, interpretation, and prediction, readers should follow any consequential factual claim to a named primary source. It is best used for orientation and topic discovery.

Stable source record

11 Why We Need an AI-Resilient Society

PREPRINT / ESSAY

arXiv:1912.08786v4

Frames resilience as a societal capacity rather than a property of a single aligned model. That perspective supports the report's insistence that governance must address institutions, dependency, and power as well as technical safeguards. The paper predates Magnifica Humanitas in origin despite later revision, so it should be used as conceptual antecedent rather than evidence of a 2026 response to the encyclical.

Stable source record

12 LLMs Bullshit by Design: A Reply to Licon

SCHOLARLY REPLY

Hicks, Humphries, and Slater, 2026

Develops a philosophical account of large language models as optimized for convincing linguistic performance without an intrinsic commitment to truth, using Frankfurt's technical notion of "bullshit." This sharpens the report's discussion of sycophancy and epistemic risk. It is an argumentative philosophical paper, not a behavioral benchmark; claims about prevalence or model mechanisms require separate empirical support.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report's original locator.

13 Anthropic’s Co-Founder Sat Next to the Pope Today

COMMUNITY DISCUSSION

Reddit discussion thread, r/claudexplorers, 2026

Documents an informal reaction to Christopher Olah’s participation in the encyclical launch. It is useful as a trace of community attention and as a pointer toward the official event record. It is not a reliable source for Anthropic’s institutional position, the content of private consultations, or technical claims about model consciousness. Verify those points through first-party statements or scholarly work.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report’s original locator.

14 Pope vs Anthropic: Why “AI Consciousness” Is Dividing Silicon Valley and Vatican

JOURNALISM

Times of India, 2026

Frames the ontological disagreement between theological anthropology and claims about machine consciousness for a general audience. It is useful for mapping the controversy and identifying named participants. The conflict framing can compress nuanced positions, and journalism cannot substitute for the cited philosophical or scientific sources. Use it as reception evidence and a lead to primary interviews or papers.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report’s original locator.

15 Artificial Persons

PREPRINT

Ned Howells-Whitaker and Seth Lazar. arXiv:2607.08695, 2026

Shifts the personhood debate away from sentience alone by asking whether an AI could possess Rawlsian moral powers: a sense of justice and a conception of the good. The authors do not claim current systems meet that standard. This paper is a valuable counterpoint to the report’s hard ontological boundary, because it shows that political personhood and phenomenal consciousness can be separated conceptually.

Stable source record

16 Why Anthropic Is Turning to Religion to Shape Claude's Values

JOURNALISM

The Indian Express, 2026

Reports on Anthropic's engagement with religious thinkers and the wider debate about model values and possible consciousness. Its strength is accessibly connecting institutional practice with intellectual context. Its limitation is the usual one for explanatory journalism: selected quotations and narrative framing do not establish a laboratory's full position or validate metaphysical claims. Use it for chronology and public statements, then consult original materials.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report's original locator.

17 Pope Leo XIV's Magnifica Humanitas and Its Connection to the Earth Charter

INSTITUTIONAL COMMENTARY

Earth Charter International, 2026

Compares the encyclical with Earth Charter themes such as ecological stewardship, justice, and responsibility to marginalized communities. This is a useful cross-framework interpretation for the report's political-economy and sustainability sections. Because the source represents an advocacy institution, it demonstrates thematic alignment rather than independent empirical validation. It should be paired with primary texts from both traditions.

Stable source record

18 Seemingly Conscious AI Risks

WORKING PAPER

Ben Bariach, Philipp Schoenegger, Michael Bhaskar, and Mustafa Suleyman. SSRN, 2026

Builds a taxonomy around user attribution of consciousness rather than the unresolved fact of machine consciousness. It identifies affective, anthropomorphic, autonomous, self-reflective, and social-interactive cues, then links them to individual and societal risks. The expert survey is exploratory, not a population estimate, and the taxonomy is not proof that any system is conscious. Its practical value is focusing governance on observable perception and dependence.

Stable source record

19 From Protocols to Evidence: Bounded Claims for AI in Service of the Common Good (PDF listing)

DUPLICATE ACCESS POINT

Chawla and Benanti, 2026

This item is the PDF version of reference 8, not a distinct scholarly contribution. Retaining it in the report's works cited inflates the apparent source count and can confuse citation tracking. Consolidate references 8 and 19 into one bibliographic record, with the conference DOI or arXiv record as the stable locator. The substantive annotation is therefore the same as entry 8.

Stable source record

20 To Trust or to Think: Cognitive Forcing Functions Can Reduce Overreliance on AI in AI-Assisted Decision-Making

PEER-REVIEWED HCI STUDY

Buçinca, Malaya, and Gajos, 2021

Provides empirical grounding for the report's call for "useful friction." Cognitive forcing interventions can prompt users to engage their own reasoning rather than reflexively accepting AI recommendations. The study supports a design principle, not a universal guarantee: effects depend on task, interface, incentives, and user population. It is especially relevant when operationalizing the Empowerment dimension of RISE.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report's original locator.

21 The Industrialization of Research: On AI-Driven Science and Its Consequences

RESEARCH ESSAY

Emmanuel Jeannot. Inria Research Report 9623; arXiv:2607.15164, 2026

Describes AI-driven science as a shift from craft practice to automated pipelines and identifies risks including competence erosion, theory opacity, peer-review overload, agenda capture, closed-loop error, and global bifurcation. The report uses it effectively to distinguish research output from human comprehension. It is a conceptual research essay rather than an empirical measurement of those harms, so its seven concerns are a governance agenda, not settled outcomes.

Stable source record

22 Five Key Paragraphs from Pope Leo XIV's Magnifica Humanitas

RELIGIOUS COMMENTARY

Ascension Press, 2026

Selects and explains passages for a Catholic popular audience. It can help readers identify prominent themes and pastoral implications, but editorial selection determines what appears "key." Use it as a reading companion, not as a replacement for the complete encyclical or a neutral content analysis. Any paragraph-level claim should be checked against the official text and its surrounding argument.

Stable source record

23 Values Hierarchy (figure attributed to Van de Poel, 2013)

DISCOVERY ARTIFACT

ResearchGate figure page

An isolated figure can illustrate how abstract values connect to norms and design requirements, but it strips away definitions, method, and argumentative context. The report's bibliography should cite Van de Poel's original 2013 publication rather than a reposted image. As listed, this source is useful only for locating the underlying work; it cannot support independent claims about value-sensitive design.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report's original locator.

24 Steven Umbrello publications profile

AUTHOR PROFILE

PhilPeople

An author profile helps locate publications and verify a researcher's broader body of work. It is not itself a scholarly source and should not be cited for the insufficiency critique. The bibliography should point directly to Umbrello's journal editorial in entry 7. The report's profile URL also appears malformed, reinforcing the need to replace it with the stable article or DOI record.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report's original locator.

25 Steven Umbrello profile

AUTHOR PROFILE / DUPLICATE

PhilPeople

A second profile listing duplicates entry 24 and adds no evidentiary support. It should be removed from a cleaned bibliography or moved to a researcher-discovery note. Counting both profile pages alongside articles obscures the difference between evidence and finding aids. The substantive source remains the 2026 Journal of Ethics and Emerging Technologies editorial.

No stable record independently added here; verify through the report's original locator.

26 Overture

PREPRINT

arXiv:2609.28591, 2026

The report lists this title without enough bibliographic detail to establish its precise role in the argument. A responsible reader should inspect the abstract, authorship, and cited passage before relying on it. Until that mapping is explicit, treat the item as a provisional lead rather than support for claims about autonomous research, education, or alignment. This entry is a good example of why annotations need claim-level provenance.

Stable source record

27 A Principled Way to Think About AI in Education

PREPRINT

arXiv:2510.01467, 2025

Offers a framework for evaluating educational uses of AI beyond simple efficiency, emphasizing learning goals, human agency, and institutional design. It supports the report's focus on preserving productive struggle and discernment. As a principles paper, it helps structure decisions but does not by itself validate specific classroom interventions. Readers should pair it with empirical studies of learning outcomes and teacher practice.

Stable source record

28 A Conceptual Architecture for Educational Digital Twins Supporting AI Literacy

PREPRINT / CONCEPT PAPER

Antonio Bucchiarone, Riccardo Belliato, Judith Michael, and Michael Mittermaier. arXiv:2607.10013, 2026

Presents the AIM-PRO project's architecture for digital representations of educators and learners across higher education, vocational training, and professional learning. It supports the report's proposal that adaptive systems can build AI literacy under human pedagogical control. Because the paper is conceptual, it establishes design components and research objectives rather than demonstrated learning gains. Privacy, agency, and educator oversight remain central evaluation questions.

Stable source record

29 AI and the Human Person: A Theologian on Magnifica Humanitas

EXPERT COMMENTARY

America Magazine, 2026

Interprets the encyclical through theological anthropology and clarifies why embodiment, relationship, responsibility, and spiritual growth matter to its account of the human person. This is a strong secondary source for religious meaning and public reception. It does not settle empirical questions about cognition or AI consciousness, and it should be read alongside the encyclical and philosophical counterarguments such as Artificial Persons.

Stable source record

Why this page has two entries

Entries 28 and 29 close the report's list. The remaining space is intentional: it keeps the final annotations readable rather than padding the bibliography with unlisted sources.

07

Start with the strongest chain of evidence

The report's central thesis is most defensible when theological claims, technical evidence, human-factors research, and governance proposals remain distinct but connected.

Question	Best starting points	What they establish
What does the encyclical argue?	Official Vatican text; entries 5 and 29	Primary doctrine, then expert interpretation.
Why is technical alignment insufficient?	Entries 7 and 8	Public legitimacy and bounded governance claims.
How can apparent consciousness harm users?	Entry 18; compare entry 15	Perception risk, with a philosophical counterpoint.
How should interfaces preserve judgment?	Entries 8 and 20	Governance architecture plus human-factors evidence.
What changes in science and education?	Entries 21, 27, and 28	Conceptual risks and design directions, not settled outcomes.

Clean-up decisions for future editions

Merge entries 8 and 19; remove entries 24 and 25 as evidence; replace entry 23 with Van de Poel's original publication; map entry 26 to the precise claim it supports; and add the official Vatican text as the primary theological source.

Interpretive discipline. Theology, philosophy, experimental human-computer interaction, and governance design answer different questions. The bibliography is strongest when it uses each source only for the claim type its method can support.

08

Read from authority to implementation

This sequence moves from the authoritative theological source to technical critique, governance, human factors, and finally forward-looking applications.

01 **Read the primary text selectively.** Begin with the encyclical's sections on human dignity, work, education, political economy, and lethal autonomy.

02 **Use Umbrello to frame the insufficiency critique.** Keep the claim institutional: the problem is who chooses values and under what authority.

03 **Use RISE to translate principles into bounded claims.** Record population, workflow, model version, institutional baseline, and limits of measurement.

04 **Pair SCAI risk with Artificial Persons.** This prevents the bibliography from treating one contested ontology as settled.

05 **Add human-factors evidence.** Cognitive forcing functions make "useful friction" testable rather than rhetorical.

06 **Separate foresight from findings.** Science and education sources identify plausible trajectories; deployed outcomes still require empirical evaluation.

Core seven-source set

Official Vatican text; Umbrello's insufficiency critique; Chawla and Benanti's RISE framework; Bariach and colleagues on seemingly conscious AI; Howells-Whitaker and Lazar on artificial persons; Buçinca and colleagues on cognitive forcing; and Jeannot on AI-driven science.

Bottom line. The bibliography supports a serious interdisciplinary argument, but only after source types are separated, duplicate and locator-only items are cleaned up, and the official encyclical is restored as the interpretive anchor.